

# A Working Framework for ResonantOS Meetings

## Objective

This document proposes a current working framework for understanding the meetings and recurring forums within the ResonantOS community. It distinguishes them first by their primary purpose, then considers other practical criteria such as expected result, access, participation, authority, preparation, and what should remain afterward.

The objective is to make every meeting easier to understand at a glance. A member should be able to tell what a meeting is about, why it may be relevant, whether it is useful for them to attend, how they may participate, and what effect the meeting can have. The same framework should help organizers set appropriate expectations without turning every gathering into an administrative process.

Status: This is a proposal for discussion. It is not policy, a final taxonomy, a complete account of meetings, or a statement of community consensus. Its categories and practices are candidates to test and revise.

## Why distinguish meetings?

Different meetings need different expectations. A learning session should not carry the preparation burden of a consequential decision. A social gathering should not be judged by the number of action items it produces. A building session and a review may involve many of the same people, yet need different facilitation and leave different kinds of memory.

## A small purpose-based taxonomy

The seven candidates below are deliberately ordinary. They are not claims about the essence of meetings. They are a practical vocabulary to test against actual ResonantOS activity.

### 1. Orientation and learning

**Primary purpose:** Help people gain context, knowledge, or capability.

**Expected useful result:** Participants leave better able to understand the project, navigate it, or perform something. Questions and gaps in the material may also become visible.

### 2. Coordination

**Primary purpose:** Align people who are already carrying related work.

**Expected useful result:** Dependencies, priorities, responsibilities, timing, and blockers are clearer; relevant next steps have owners.

### 3. Working and building

**Primary purpose:** Produce or materially advance something together during the meeting.

**Expected useful result:** A draft, design, implementation, analysis, plan, repaired problem, or other inspectable increment exists afterward.

### 5. Decision

**Primary purpose:** Make a choice that has an identified effect within an explicit scope.

**Expected useful result:** A decision is stated, its scope and rationale are understandable, and follow-through is assigned or routed.

### 4. Deliberation

**Primary purpose:** Examine a consequential question, surface perspectives, and improve the quality of a possible choice without necessarily making the choice in the meeting.

**Expected useful result:** Options, trade-offs, assumptions, disagreements, and areas of convergence are clearer; the question may be ready for a decision elsewhere.

### 6. Review and reflection

**Primary purpose:** Learn from completed or ongoing activity and adjust future practice.

**Expected useful result:** What happened, what helped or hindered, and what should change next are more explicit.

### 7. Community and relationship

**Primary purpose:** Build trust, belonging, mutual understanding, care, or celebration.

**Expected useful result:** Relationships are strengthened, newcomers find connection, or a shared moment is recognized. The result may be real without being reducible to tasks.

At the same time, standardizing every detail would create bureaucracy. Organizers should not have to complete a large template to host a useful conversation. The practical question is therefore: what is the smallest set of meeting types and common patterns that helps people understand what they are entering, without making meetings harder to convene?

This proposal uses primary purpose as the basis for type. A type answers, “What main change should this meeting produce?” It does not answer every other question. “Town hall,” “workshop,” and “weekly call” describe formats or rhythms. “Public,” “member-only,” and “small group” describe access or audience. “Advisory” and “authorized to decide” describe authority. Any of these can combine with more than one purpose, so they should normally be stated separately rather than treated as types.

A meeting can serve several purposes. The suggestion is to name one primary type for orientation and, when genuinely helpful, one secondary purpose. “Hybrid” should not become a way to avoid saying what result matters most.

## 01 1. Orientation and learning

### Proportionate treatment:

State the intended audience and learning aim. Share preparation only when prior context is truly needed; introductory sessions should normally minimize prerequisites. Clarify whether questions, exercises, or peer teaching are invited. Attendance gives access to learning, not authority over the subject or project. Retain the materials, useful explanations, and unresolved questions when they will help others; a recording is optional, not the default meaning of transparency.

### Open question:

*Should onboarding and skills training remain one type, or do real cases show different enough treatment to separate them?*

## 02 2. Coordination

### Proportionate treatment:

Circulate a short status or agenda only when it saves meeting time. Invite the people whose work is affected, while making observer and contributor roles clear. State whether the group only coordinates existing commitments or may change priorities within a delegated scope. Retain decisions about sequencing, owners, deadlines, and blockers; routine spoken status need not become a permanent record.

### Open question:

*When does coordination become deliberation or decision, and should the meeting be reclassified when that happens regularly?*

## 03 3. Working and building

### Proportionate treatment:

Name the object of work and provide the tools, permissions, or source material needed to contribute. Participation is active by design, but different roles may still be useful: builder, reviewer, facilitator, or observer. Clarify who may accept changes or merge the result; co-presence does not itself grant that authority. Preserve the resulting artifact, major choices, and remaining work rather than a transcript of the session.

### Open question:

*Do collaborative planning and hands-on building need separate labels, or is their shared treatment more important than the distinction?*

## 04 4. Deliberation

### Proportionate treatment:

Frame the question and provide a concise pre-read when informed participation depends on it. Make participation rules and facilitation visible enough that relevant perspectives can enter. State who is being advised and whether the meeting may recommend an option. Retain the options considered, important reasoning, unresolved objections, and any recommendation. Do not present discussion sentiment as a decision or consensus.

### Open question:

*What evidence is enough to say a deliberation has produced a recommendation rather than only useful discussion?*

## 05 5. Decision

### Proportionate treatment:

This type needs the clearest preparation and authority boundary. Share the decision question, relevant options, constraints, and required material early enough for responsible participation. Name who may advise, recommend, and decide, and on what basis; access to the meeting and participation in discussion do not create decision rights. Retain the decision, scope, responsible decision-maker or body, rationale, material objections, date, and follow-up. Recording the whole meeting remains optional unless a separate need justifies it.

### Open question:

*Which decisions, if any, can current ResonantOS forums make, and where must they instead advise or recommend?*

## 06 6. Review and reflection

### Proportionate treatment:

Bring the artifact, evidence, or experience being reviewed; avoid demanding elaborate reports when a small sample is enough. Create conditions for candid participation, including privacy where justified. Clarify whether the group can approve work, change a process, or only offer feedback. Retain findings, agreed adjustments, owners, and open questions. Personal or sensitive reflections should not be made durable merely because they were spoken.

During a pilot, state whether artifact evaluation or team reflection is the primary purpose. If both are present, name the secondary purpose and follow whichever privacy or authority treatment is stricter.

### Open question:

*Should evaluation of an artifact and reflection on a team's experience share one type when their privacy and authority needs may differ?*

## 07 7. Community and relationship

### Proportionate treatment:

Keep preparation light unless an activity benefits from it. Make the intended social setting and participation norms welcoming and clear, without turning presence into a performance obligation. These meetings normally carry no decision authority unless separately declared. Retain little by default: perhaps public resources, volunteered announcements, or agreed follow-ups. Protect informal and personal conversation from automatic capture.

### Open question:

*Are care-oriented gatherings sufficiently different from social or celebratory ones to need their own treatment?*

## A minimal pattern for every meeting

If the taxonomy is useful, it should reduce uncertainty with very little administration. Organizers should consider five questions for every scheduled meeting, then make visible only the answers participants need. Higher-consequence meetings need more explicit answers; low-stakes meetings may answer some in a few words and omit what is genuinely irrelevant:

1. Purpose and expected result: Why are we meeting, and what would make the time useful?
2. Access and participation: Who may attend or observe, and what forms of participation are invited or expected?
3. Authority: Is the meeting informing, advising, recommending, coordinating within existing commitments, or deciding within an explicit delegated scope?
4. Preparation: Is anything required beforehand? If not, say nothing or say "none."
5. Memory: What useful result, if any, will remain afterward, and who can access it?

## This prompt set protects several distinctions that names alone cannot carry:

**Access is not participation.** Being able to enter or observe does not necessarily mean having a speaking or working role.

**Participation is not decision authority.** Contributing ideas, labor, or advice does not automatically grant power to determine the outcome.

**Transparency does not require recording.** A clear purpose, visible boundaries, and an accessible summary may provide useful transparency without capturing every word.

**Attendance is not automatically contribution.** Showing up may enable contribution and relationship, but presence alone should not be treated as proof of useful work or as a basis for authority.

These statements are proposed safeguards, not a complete participation, governance, transparency, or contribution policy.

## Conditional patterns, only when the stakes require them

Some practices should be triggered by need rather than imposed on every meeting:

- Use a pre-read when a substantive deliberation or decision depends on shared information.
- Use stronger facilitation, turn-taking, or consent checks when power differences, conflict, accessibility, or sensitive subjects make ordinary conversation insufficient.
- Name a quorum or formal decision method only where an authorized process requires one.
- Use restricted access or restricted notes when privacy, safety, confidentiality, or candid reflection justifies the boundary.
- Make a recording only when it serves a clear purpose, participants have appropriate notice and consent, and retention and access are understood.
- Track actions, decisions, recommendations, or open questions when they need to survive the call and reach the people or place where follow-up happens.

The burden should follow consequence. A casual social gathering may need only a short purpose plus a clear access and participation note; preparation, authority, and retained memory may be irrelevant. A decision with durable effects may need a question, pre-read, explicit authority, structured participation, and a durable decision record.

## Recurring context and a specific meeting

A recurring forum may keep a stable purpose, organizer, usual audience, whether it informs, advises, recommends, or decides, preparation norm, and memory practice.

A specific occurrence has a date, topic, expected result, participants, and actual outcomes.

Keeping these levels distinct can prevent two common failures: repeatedly explaining stable expectations, and allowing an old series description to obscure what happened in a particular meeting.

This does not require two elaborate documents. A short standing description plus occurrence-specific invitations and result notes may be enough. If a forum's purpose or authority changes, its standing description should be revisited rather than silently inherited.

## What should remain flexible

This proposal should not standardize facilitation style, length, cadence, group size, software, tone, agenda format, naming convention, or whether conversation is formal. It should not require every meeting to be public, every participant to speak, every result to become permanent, or every recurring forum to use the same template.

Type names should also remain revisable. A meeting's purpose and expected result matter more than forcing familiar activity into a neat box. Organizers should be able to combine purposes when necessary, provided the primary purpose and authority remain legible. Communities also need room for spontaneity, privacy, experimentation, and gatherings whose value is relational rather than documentary.

## Questions for the group

Before adopting any common practice, it would be useful to discuss:

1. Do these seven types help you predict what preparation, participation, authority, and memory a meeting needs?
2. Which types feel redundant, missing, or misleading in actual ResonantOS work?
3. Can a newcomer distinguish coordination, deliberation, and decision from the descriptions alone?
4. Is one primary type plus an optional secondary purpose enough for mixed meetings?
5. Are the five prompt questions small enough to consider consistently, with answers recorded only when useful?
6. Which conditional practices need clearer triggers, especially for privacy and decision-making?
7. What should a recurring forum state once, and what must each occurrence restate?

A lightweight next step would be to try the candidates on a small set of real or upcoming meetings for four to six weeks. Organizers could consider the five prompt questions, record only the answers participants need, choose a tentative type, and note where the language feels forced or the treatment is disproportionate. Participants, especially newcomers and occasional attendees, could then say whether expectations were clearer. The result should be a short learning review: keep what helped, revise what confused, and remove what created maintenance without value.

That pilot would test the proposal. It would not ratify a taxonomy or create authority that no forum currently holds.